

KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

Saint Barthélemy

A few practical notes for your week in St. Barths — currency, tipping, language, and the rest of the small things that make travel feel easy.

PASSPORT & ENTRY

Valid passport required

St. Barths is a French overseas collectivity. US citizens do not need a visa for stays under 90 days. Make sure your passport is valid for at least three months beyond your return date.

TIPPING

Service is typically included

Restaurants include service (service compris). An extra 5–10% for excellent service is appreciated but not expected. \$5–10 per service is gracious for drivers, beach attendants, and concierge.

TIME & WEATHER

AST · warm, dry, breezy in May

Atlantic Standard Time (UTC–4) — same as US Eastern in summer. Mid-May runs 78–85°F with low humidity and steady trade winds. Pack a light layer for evenings on the water.

CONNECTIVITY

US carriers cover the island

T-Mobile, AT&T, and Verizon all reach St. Barths — check your international plan before you leave. Wi-Fi is standard at Fouquet's and most restaurants.

CURRENCY & PAYMENTS

Euro is official; USD widely accepted

Most hotels, restaurants, and beach clubs take USD and major credit cards. Some smaller boutiques are euro-only. ATMs are available in Gustavia.

LANGUAGE

French, with English everywhere in tourism

French is the official language; English is widely spoken at hotels, restaurants, and beach clubs. A bonjour on arrival and merci on departure goes a long way.

POWER & PLUGS

220V · European Type C / E

Two-prong European outlets. Most modern phone and laptop chargers handle 220V automatically — check the fine print on the brick. Bring a Continental Europe adapter for anything single-voltage.

DRIVING THE MOKE

Right-hand traffic · narrow, winding roads

Your US driver's license is valid. Roads are steep, narrow, and scenic — drive slowly and confidently. The Moke is open-air; toss a light jacket and a hat in the back for windy stretches.